

an optional author name, determine the location to which it will be saved (by default, it saves your slideshow to a folder named 'My Slide Show' under 'My Documents'), the picture sizes, and so on. You can choose between a simple slideshow and a more advanced one that offers thumbnails. You can also determine whether the slideshow plays in a normal browser window or in full-screen mode. The finished product is good, but with two serious flaws:

First, you must be running IE to display the slideshows correctly. Second, if you've upgraded to SP2, then the slideshows you create with this tool generate a lot of Active Content Protection errors.

Image Resizer

This little PowerToy allows you to resize a picture or group of pictures without changing the originals. It works in a manner similar to the 'Send Pictures via E-mail' functionality that's built into Windows XP, but with easier control over the sizing options, and with the batching functionality for resizing multiple images at the same time.

To use this PowerToy, select any image or group of images, right-click, and select 'Resize Pictures'. The 'Resize

Pictures' dialog will appear, giving you options to resize the images at 640 x 480 (Small), 800 x 600 (Medium), 1024 x 768 (Large) or 240 x 320 (Handheld PC-sized, for Windows CE-based Pocket PC and other handheld devices). When you resize the images, new versions are created with slightly different file names by default. For example, if you resize an image called "Digit Magazine" to Large, it will be renamed "Digit Magazine (Large)".

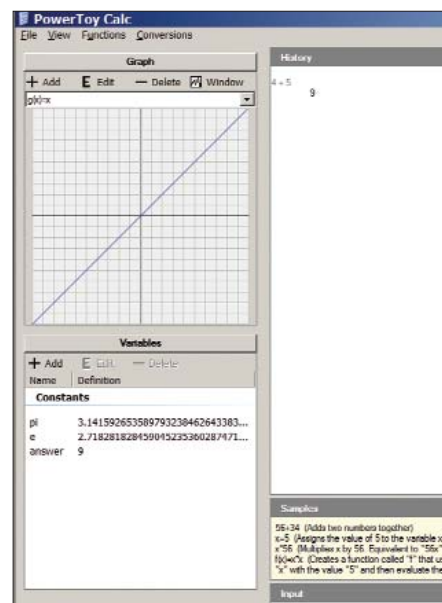
There is also an 'Advanced' button you can use to enable more options. This includes a choice to make images smaller during conversion, but not larger, and one that will replace the original rather than make a copy.

Command Window Here

This PowerToy adds an 'Open Command Window Here' item in the right-click context menu. You just need to right-click a folder and choose 'Open Command Window Here', and a DOS command window will open in that folder rather than in the root, which is the default. This PowerToy is a must-have if you use the command line often!

Power Calculator

The calculator app that ships with Windows XP is adequate for basic maths



The Power Calculator gives you many more options than the standard Windows calculator

calculations, but you might often find yourself looking for additional functionality. The Power Calculator provides those additional features including functions, graphing, precision settings, and basic but useful conversions.

Virtual Desktop Manager

Windows NT has always had the ability to generate multiple desktop displays. Now you can get one free for XP. The PowerToys version of this tool lets you work with up to four virtual desktops, each of which contains a copy of the Start Menu, Desktop, and Taskbar—each virtual desktop can be running different applications. So if you're a serious power user, you might separate groups of running applications into their own Desktops.

To launch the Virtual Desktop Manager, right-click the Taskbar, choose Toolbars, and then Desktop Manager. This will add a new toolbar to the Taskbar that lets you switch between the virtual Desktops, numbered 1 through 4. It also provides a button that

lets you manage the Desktops.

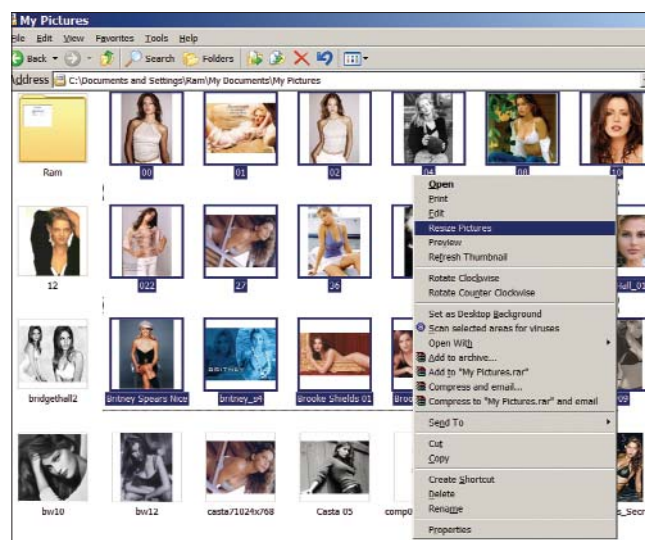
Taskbar Magnifier

This is similar to the Magnifier tool that comes with XP (Start > Programs > Accessories > Accessibility), providing screen magnification capabilities. The difference is that the PowerToys version sits in the Taskbar and, as a result, offers a smaller viewing area. To activate this PowerToy, right-click the

Taskbar and select 'Taskbar', then 'Taskbar Magnifier'. If you right-click the PowerToy, you get options for following



The magnifier helps those with vision problems to clearly make out text and icons



The Image Resizer will let you easily resize images into predefined sizes such as 640 x 480 or 1024 x 768

the mouse cursor and keyboard focus, and a setting for the zoom level (1x to 8x; 2x is the default).

TweakUI for Windows XP

The XP version of TweakUI is the best version yet (it was a standard Control Panel applet that came with Windows 95). Basically, TweakUI for Windows XP brings up a user interface for numerous system settings that are not normally exposed through the default XP interface. Most of these options would have previously required you to edit the Registry.